

capacity vehicles (buses) in several cities. We see that [diversification] playing out as a part of his push to be more relevant to a larger consumer base. Our technology centre in Bengaluru is one of the largest globally, outside the US. We build full-stack tech solutions here for global operations. His view is that in the spirit of being disruptive, sometimes we antagonise local stakeholders like unions. He encourages local teams to find common ground with policymakers.

Q: In India's cut-throat competitive market, how does Uber differentiate itself and stay ahead of the competition?

A: India is a large market; it has multiple ride-hailing players, so it will remain a competitive space. What matters is, are we doing the right thing for the consumers and drivers? For consumers, our focus is to be consistently reliable, affordable and safer. If we fail on either of these three, consumers will shift. Drivers have a choice. They can switch between multiple apps, or go off the app to travel operators, which means they will choose a platform that gives them the maximum earning opportunity, which also treats them with respect, and one that has their back when things go wrong. We just focus on these three things.

Q: Reliability and affordability are concerns for consumers. How are you addressing this?

A: There was a phase after the pandemic when cancellations spiked on the platform. The reliability promise took a hit. We really had to double down to ensure that this improves. Through a bunch of driver-obsessed changes and tech innovations, service quality has improved over the past 12 months. Compared to a year ago, cancellations are down 95 per cent, and completion rate from vehicles are more than 10 percentage points above. Today, more drivers are coming to the Uber platform than other ride-hailing platforms. Pre-Covid-19, our active driver base was about half a million, now we are at about 800,000 drivers (across all segments). Even in cars, we have more active cars on the platform than we ever had. Over the next two years, more than 150,000-200,000 new cars are going to enter [our platform], and replace the old ones. It will improve the physical experience of the customers.

We look at affordability from three dimensions. We are a two-sided marketplace, the marketplace will scale only if we offer fair earnings to the drivers, and reasonable prices for the passengers. When the cost of inputs for drivers goes up—like the cost of a vehicle which went up, cost of fuel increased by about 40 per cent post the pandemic and the oil crisis—we had to translate that into increased prices for passengers so that the drivers are compensated fairly. Often our



“We have built an incredibly strong top line and scale, and are growing fast. On the bottom line, we have made tremendous progress. We run a very disciplined business. We have proven we can run a strong, economically viable business in a low-fare market like India”
